

SPACE XPO2026

National Space Innovation Challenge

Official Rulebook

1. Introduction

The **Space Axpo – National Space Innovation Challenge (NSIC)** is a national-level innovation competition aimed at encouraging students and innovators to develop practical solutions for real-world challenges in space technology. The event provides a platform to transform innovative ideas into working prototypes under the guidance of experts from academia and industry.

2. Eligibility

The competition is open to:

- Diploma Students
 - Undergraduate Students
 - Postgraduate Students
 - Engineering Students
 - Science Students
 - Robotics Clubs
 - Astronomy Clubs
 - Innovation Cells
 - Makers and Hobbyists
 - Individuals aged 16 years or above
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3. Team Composition

- Each team must consist of **2–5 members**.
 - A participant can be a member of **only one team**.
 - Team composition cannot be changed after the registration deadline unless approved by the organizing committee.
 - One team can consist students from different college.
 - Every team must appoint one Team Leader for all official communication.
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4. Competition Categories

The competition consists of two independent categories:

Software Category

Solutions based on software, AI/ML, simulations, data analysis, web/mobile applications, satellite data processing, mission planning, visualization, etc.

Hardware Category

Solutions involving electronics, embedded systems, robotics, IoT, autonomous systems, mechanical prototypes, and related technologies.

5. Competition Structure

- 8 hours for development
 - Develop the prototype
 - Demonstrate their solution
 - Present before the judging panel
 - Participate in a Q&A session
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6. Registration

- Registration must be completed through the official registration portal.
- The registration fee is applicable for all teams.
- Registration fees are non-refundable unless the event is cancelled by the organizers.

7. Deliverables

Each team must submit:

- Working Prototype
 - Presentation (PPT)
 - Source Code or GitHub Repository
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8. General Rules

1. Teams must work only on the allotted or selected problem statement.
 2. Participants must maintain professional conduct throughout the event.
 3. Problem statement cannot be changed once selected.
 4. Any form of plagiarism is strictly prohibited.
 5. Projects copied from existing repositories or previous competitions will be disqualified.
 6. Snacks will be provided by the ASX Team.
 7. Internet access is permitted unless otherwise announced.
 8. Open-source libraries and frameworks may be used with proper attribution.
 9. Teams are responsible for ensuring that their submissions do not violate any copyrights or patents.
 10. Organizers reserve the right to inspect any source code or hardware prototype.
 11. Teams must submit all deliverables before the announced deadline.
 12. Late submissions may not be accepted.
 13. Prize money may be withheld, if any cheating, plagiarism, misconduct, or dispute is discovered during or after the competition.
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9. Hardware Category Rules

- Teams must bring their own hardware unless specified otherwise.
- Electrical safety must be maintained at all times.
- Unsafe or hazardous equipment is prohibited.

- Batteries and power supplies must comply with venue safety guidelines.
 - The Hardware components team brings will be checked prior to the competition.
 - Organizers reserve the right to stop demonstrations that pose safety risks.
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10. Software Category Rules

- Software must function on the demonstration system.
 - Teams should carry backup copies of their project.
 - The source code must be accessible to judges upon request.
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11. Judging Criteria

Projects will be evaluated based on:

- Innovation
- Problem Understanding
- Technical Feasibility
- Prototype Quality
- Space Relevance
- Scalability
- Presentation Skills
- Social and Industrial Impact

The judges' decision shall be final and binding.

12. Presentation Guidelines

Each finalist team will receive:

- **15 minutes** for project presentation and question-and-answer session.
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13. Code of Conduct

All participants are expected to:

- Respect fellow participants, judges, volunteers, and organizers.
- Maintain discipline throughout the event.
- Avoid abusive language or disruptive behavior.
- Follow all venue rules and safety instructions.
- Wear their participant ID card during the event.

Violation of the code of conduct may result in disqualification.

14. Intellectual Property

- Intellectual Property (IP) developed during the competition remains with the participating team.
 - Space Axpo reserves the right to publish project summaries, photographs, videos, and demonstrations for promotional purposes.
 - Teams are encouraged to file patents for novel innovations independently.
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15. Disqualification

A team may be disqualified for:

- Plagiarism
- False information during registration
- Misconduct
- Violation of safety guidelines
- Cheating or unfair practices
- Failure to comply with event rules
- Offensive or inappropriate behavior

The decision of the organizing committee will be final.

16. Prizes

Prizes will be awarded separately for:

Software Category

- **First Prize:** ₹15,000 + ₹10,000 Worth Stargazing Event Passes
- **Second Prize:** ₹10,000 + ₹5,000 Worth Stargazing Event Passes

Hardware Category

- **First Prize:** ₹15,000 + ₹10,000 Worth Stargazing Event Passes
- **Second Prize:** ₹10,000 + ₹5,000 Worth Stargazing Event Passes

Additional awards may be introduced at the discretion of the organizers.

17. Liability

Space Axpo and the organizing committee shall not be responsible for:

- Loss of personal belongings
 - Damage to participant equipment
 - Technical failures caused by participant hardware
 - Injuries resulting from improper handling of equipment
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18. Amendments

The organizing committee reserves the right to modify, update, or interpret these rules whenever necessary to ensure the smooth conduct of the competition. Any changes will be communicated through official channels.

19. Contact

Space Axpo – National Space Innovation Challenge

For all official communications regarding NSIC, participants may contact the Organizing Committee at contact@spaceaxpo.axsx.in or visit spaceaxpo.axsx.in.